

When you think of gaming, traditionally, one's mind goes to a full-fledged PC setup that costs an arm and a leg. It is also of no help that the PC components market, due to the influx of scalpers, has seen a momentous rise in prices, especially when it comes to graphics cards.

In this scenario, both the consumers and manufacturers turned to laptops. For the companies, it was a chance to make up for the lost sales on components, and for the consumers, who are loyal to the PCMR, it was a chance to get a taste of the gaming performance that PCs offer.

However, one problem arose during this migratory phase. A lot of our brethren ended up buying laptops which looked decent on paper but ended up being a boiling hot pile of garbage. We could not stand that happen to our fellow gamers who, despite all odds, did not cross the line over the world of consoles.

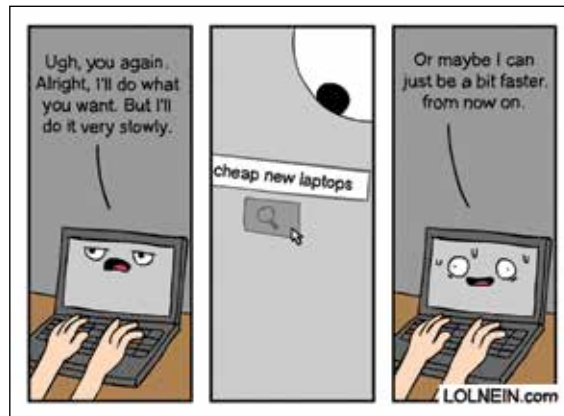
While consoles make for a decent purchase if one's looking for a decent gaming experience. But for anything more than that, laptops make more sense. At the end of the day, you have to get those bucks in to pay the bills!

So, we bring to you a short laptop guide that will help you make the best decisions when you are out in the market looking for a gaming laptop. And if you already have one, we

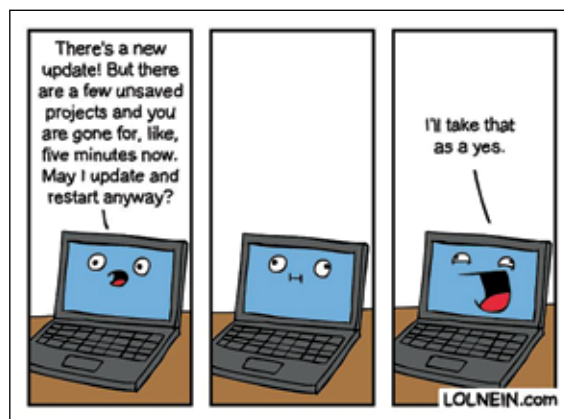
also have something in store for you too!

What to look for in your dream battlestation

If you are out in the market and looking to buy a gaming laptop, then the time is right. Almost all the major players in the market, like MSI, HP, and Lenovo, are pumping out some great machines that too at reasonable prices.



SOURCE: LOLNEIN



We all hate that, don't we?

The question that remains is what to look for when buying a gaming laptop. Well, we have you covered. When buying a gaming laptop, you should pay special attention to the following things:

Your use case: Just go to the PCMR subreddit, and you will see hundreds of posts with users buying hardware that is too overpowered for their use case. We recently did a cover story about how geeks should

manage their money, and one of the highlights was that you should keep your spending in check. If all you are going to do is play occasional games of CS:GO and type out word documents, then spending a ton of money over buying a top-of-the-line gaming laptop does not make sense at all. So, when you set out to buy your laptop, your first step should be to factor in what games you will play and what other things you will be doing.

Do you need an upgrade: Once you have charted out what you are going to do with your shiny new laptop, take a step back. Ask yourself and your old machine – Is there a need to get an upgrade? If you are planning to buy your first system, then skip this part. Run some basic benchmarks and test out the performance of your machine. Some benchmarks that we use at SKOAR! to gauge the capabilities of the machines that we get are:

3D Mark: It is one of the most comprehensive gaming benchmarks out there. There are different variations of the benchmark that are used for different use cases targeting different classes of hardware. You can find a complete guide to the benchmarks here:

<https://dgit.in/3DMarkBM>.

The benchmarks that we primarily use are –

PCMark 10: PCMark 10 tests almost everything apart from gaming performance of your system. PCMark 10 Appli-

cations benchmark includes the following tests: Word test, Excel test, PowerPoint test, and Edge test. The scores from this benchmark will help you gauge what your system is capable of in terms of day-to-day non-gaming use.

Once you are through with running the benchmarks, compare the scores of your old machine with that of the current-gen laptops that are available in your target budget. If the difference

Gamers look at the prices of PC parts:

